University of St.Gallen

Course and Examination Fact Sheet: Autumn Semester 2025

9,008: IC: Lean Product and Outsourcing Management

ECTS credits: 4

Overview examination/s

(binding regulations see below)
decentral - Written work, Digital, Individual work individual grade (30%)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Presentation, Analog, Group work group grade (70%)
Examination time: Term time

Attached courses

Timetable -- Language -- Lecturer
9,008,1.00 IC: Lean Product and Outsourcing Management -- English -- Bauer-Hänsel Ingrid

Course information

Prerequisites

This course is assigned to the profiles «Business Development» and «Transforming and Managing Digital Business» but can also be taken without selecting a specialization.

Learning objectives

After successfully completing this course, students will:

- have a comprehensive understanding of lean product management as well as know the key aspects of outsourcing.
- be familiar with various frameworks, methodical procedures, and tools to get from a product idea to a prioritized list of requirements in a structured way.
- be able to apply the tools presented to make data-driven decisions and drive their own product idea forward in a value-adding way.
- know how to evaluate outsourcing vs. inhouse development and how to manage an outsourcing project.

Content

This course offers a comprehensive guide to transforming a product idea into a successful market launch using lean principles and effective outsourcing management. It is tailored for students interested in entrepreneurship and/or product management aiming to bring their innovative ideas to market, using a data-driven product-market-fit approach.

The course lecture begins with techniques how to identify target customers and pinpointing underserved needs, providing a foundation for a customer-centric approach. Participants will then learn to craft a winning product strategy and decide on their Minimum Viable Product features (MVP), ensuring a focused and strategic development process. Managing outsourcing is a critical component of the course, equipping participants with the skills to evaluate what can and what should not be outsourced, as well as to select, evaluate, and collaborate with external partners effectively. The curriculum also covers testing the MVP with real customers and iterating rapidly based on feedback. This iterative process ensures continuous improvement and alignment with customer expectations.

Further, during the practical exercise that runs along the course, participants will learn how to apply the tools from the lecture and bring their product ideas to life, creating an MVP prototype. This hands-on experience includes evaluating and managing outsourcing aspects.

Participants are encouraged to bring their own product ideas, enabling them to apply the course concepts directly to their projects.

The course is structured as follows:

- Lecture Session 1: Determine your target customers and identify underserved customer needs
- Project Work
- Lecture Session 2: Create a winning product strategy; Decide on your MVP
- Coaching Session (optional)
- Project Work
- Lecture Session 3: Managing Outsourcing
- Lecture Session 4: Test your MVP with customers & iterate rapidly
- Coaching Session (optional)
- Project Work
- Coaching Session (optional)
- Final Presentations

Project Work: Bring your own Product from Idea to a MVP Prototype based on a structured, data-driven approach and by successfully evaluating and managing outsourcing aspects.

Structure and indications of the learning and teaching design

- This course comprises 4 credits. Accordingly, the total workload for students is 120 hours. This includes self-study, attendance time and all examinations.
- The workload is planned to be distributed as follows:
    - 25 hours of lectures including preparation and follow-up time for the lectures as well as coaching sessions,
    - 65 hours of project work,
    - 30 hours of preparation time for the final examinations.
- The course will be held in hybrid form if circumstances require it, otherwise the course will be held in presence in St.Gallen.
- Further explanation of the teaching and learning design: In 4 of the 12 lecture units, the focus is on knowledge transfer by the lecturer. In further 3 lecture units, coaching session are offered and 3 units are used for the project work. The final 2 lecture sessions are used for examination (i.e. presentation of the final projects).

Literature

None in advance. These will be distributed during the course as appropriate.

Additional information

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Examination information

Examination sub part/s

1. Examination sub part (1/2)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Written work
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Written work
Examination mode	Digital
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	Off Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	30%

Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
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Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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2. Examination sub part (2/2)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Presentation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination
Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Group work group grade
Weighting	70%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
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Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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Content

The examination is decentralized in written and oral form and includes both a group performance (70%) and an individual performance (30%).

On the one hand, students work on their own product idea in groups of 2-4 students during the lecture period and present their work in a final presentation (70%). On the other hand, an individual reflection paper will have to be submitted at the end of the course (30%).

The final group presentation summarizes the project work performed during the semester and will be held in the second to last lecture week.

The individual reflection paper will reflect on the key learning from the lecture series and the project work and will have to be submitted in the last lecture week.

(Subject to change).

Literature

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Please note

Please note that only this fact sheet and the examination schedule published at the time of bidding are binding and takes precedence over other information, such as information on StudyNet (Canvas), on lecturers' websites and information in lectures etc.
Any references and links to third-party content within the fact sheet are only of a supplementary, informative nature and lie outside the area of responsibility of the University of St.Gallen.

Documents and materials are only relevant for central examinations if they are available by the end of the lecture period (CW51) at the latest. In the case of centrally organised mid-term examinations, the documents and materials up to CW 43 (Freitag, 24. October 2025) are relevant for testing.

Binding nature of the fact sheets:

- Course information as well as examination date (organised centrally/decentrally) and form of examination: from bidding start in CW 34 (Thursday, 21 August 2025);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for decentralised examinations: in CW 42 (Monday, 13. October 2025);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised mid-term examinations: in CW 43 (Freitag, 24. October 2025);
- Examination information (regulations on aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised examinations: two weeks before ending with de-registration period in CW 45 (Monday, 03. November 2025).